



Megacity

Known for business, industry, and shipping, Lagos is also a vibrant cultural hub with many universities. Set around a lagoon, it sprawls across several islands and has two enormous cargo ports.

Jollof rice
Traditional West African jollof rice is a tasty one-pot dish made of cooked meat, rice, tomatoes, onions, peppers, and spices. Jollof is often sold by vendors in marketplaces.



Palm oil
Oil extracted from the fruit of the African oil palm tree is used for cooking in many parts of Africa. Nigeria ranks among the world's largest palm oil producers.

Horses, along with their riders, are dressed in regal decorations as they parade through the streets.

Durbar festival

Celebrated in northern Nigerian cities such as Kano, this annual Islamic festival marks the end of the holy month of Ramadan and is known for its colorful parades of horse riders.



Nigerian beats

From the legendary Fela Kuti to today's Afrobeats stars, such as Burna Boy (right), Nigerian music is big worldwide.



Geography: Nigeria's varied mix of landscapes range from drier savanna to tropical forests and swampy river deltas.

History: Ancient African empires were established here thousands of years ago. Nigeria gained independence in 1960.

Culture: More than 250 ethnic groups, speaking hundreds of languages, keep traditional culture alive. Art, literature, and music thrive.

Natural wonders: These include the vast Niger River, Ogbunike Caves, tumbling waterfalls, the Ikogosi Springs, and wildlife parks.